FORGE.

Forged for the everyday.

A Clothing Brand for Pakistan / Brand Plan 2026

FOUNDED
Lahore, Pakistan / 2026

CATEGORIES
10 categories

PRICE TIER
Mid-premium / PKR 1,800-5,500

SECTION 02

Executive Summary

FORGE is a mid-premium everyday apparel and accessories brand for Pakistan launching in 2026 out of Lahore. The brand sits in a clear gap between the budget mass-market tier (LOCAL, Breakout, Edenrobe) and the premium ethnic tier (Khaadi, Sapphire, Ethnic by Ayesha) — a quiet, minimal-premium territory no domestic brand currently owns at the PKR 1,800-5,500 price band. The product line spans 10 categories — hoodies, t-shirts, sweatshirts, drop-shoulder tees, polo shirts, round-neck full-sleeve tees, printed mugs, zipper hoodies, and printed notebooks — built on a single design philosophy: essentials-first silhouettes in earth tones drawn from the forge itself — cream ash, warm black iron, terracotta ember, olive slag, and sandstone heat-patina.

The target is a deliberately mixed customer base: urban Gen-Z (18-25) in Karachi, Lahore, and Islamabad who lean streetwear; young professionals (25-35) seeking clean polo and full-sleeve options for office-casual wear; and students (16-22) who buy graphic tees, printed mugs, and notebooks as affordable identity markers. This mixed targeting is intentional — the catalog is broad enough that each persona finds 3-5 hero SKUs, while the unified earth-tone palette keeps the brand coherent.

The 12-month plan calls for approximately PKR 4.5M (~USD 16K) of startup capital to fund inventory, brand identity, e-commerce build, packaging, and initial marketing. Unit economics target a 57% gross margin (avg selling price PKR 2,200 against COGS of PKR 950). Break-even is projected at month 9-10, with month-12 monthly revenue reaching PKR 2.5M. Funding comes from founder savings, family contribution, and one angel investor. Distribution is direct-to-consumer via the brand's own Next.js storefront, with a planned Daraz marketplace expansion in Q3 and a Lahore pop-up store in Q4.

> "FORGE is not chasing the loudest corner of the market. It is building the quiet corner — the one a customer returns to season after season."

SECTION 03

Brand Story & Identity

The meaning behind the name

A forge is where raw material is heated, hammered, and shaped into something durable — a knife that holds its edge through a hundred dinners, a hinge on a door that swings for decades, a tool passed down to the next maker. Nothing leaves a forge that wasn't intentionally built. Wazirabad in Punjab has been Pakistan's forge city for over a century — the place where the country's knives, scissors, and surgical instruments are hammered into shape, where the rhythm of strike-and-cool has been the same sound for four generations. FORGE the brand takes this exact craft logic and applies it to clothing: every garment built to be re-worn 100+ wash cycles, in earth tones drawn from the forge itself — cream ash, warm black iron, terracotta ember, olive slag, sandstone heat-patina.

This naming choice is deliberate. Most Pakistani apparel brands borrow aspirational English words (Edenrobe, Sapphire) or ethnic-cultural markers (Khaadi, Ethnic) that signal status or heritage. FORGE uses a single industrial English noun — a place where craft happens, where material becomes object — with no aspirational baggage and no cultural costume. The uppercase wordmark **FORGE.** with a terminal period signals restraint and intentionality: this brand is finished thinking about itself. The tagline "Forged for the everyday." extends the metaphor explicitly: clothing built deliberately, for the layer the customer reaches for on an ordinary Tuesday.

Four brand values

Craft. Every garment is built to be re-worn across 100+ wash cycles. Seams are double-stitched on stress points, fabrics are pre-shrunk, and GSM (grams per square meter) is disclosed on every product page — a transparency move borrowed from UNIQLO and Everlane that no Pakistani competitor currently does. Craft is measured, not marketed.

Comfort. FORGE refuses the trend-chasing silhouette of the moment. Fits are relaxed but not oversized, drop-shoulder but not boxy, polo collars sit flat instead of curling. The customer should reach for the same FORGE hoodie on a Tuesday morning and a Friday night without thinking about it.

Quiet Confidence. The brand identity is intentionally restrained — no loud logos, no all-over graphics, no neon. Branding is a small woven label at the hem and a debossed wordmark on the inside collar. The clothing lets the wearer's personality lead. This is the brand's sharpest competitive differentiation: in a market saturated with logo-heavy streetwear, FORGE offers the opposite pole.

Cultural Roots. Earth tones (cream ash, warm black iron, terracotta ember, olive slag, sandstone heat-patina) reference the Pakistani forge tradition — Wazirabad cutlery, Faisalabad textile mills, Lahore brick kilns — without crossing into costume-y "ethnic" territory. Taglines and product names use Urdu transliteration sparingly. The brand is unambiguously Pakistani without performing Pakistani-ness.

SECTION 04

Market Analysis

Pakistan's domestic apparel market is estimated at over USD 15 billion in 2025, growing at roughly 8% CAGR, driven by three structural tailwinds: a youth-heavy demographic (64% of the population is under 30), rapid urbanization in Karachi, Lahore, and Islamabad, and a fast-maturing e-commerce layer (Daraz, Instagram-led D2C brands, and TikTok-driven micro-brands). Within this market, the mid-premium everyday basics segment — clothing priced between PKR 1,800 and PKR 5,500 — is the fastest-growing slice and the most under-served by current domestic players.

The competitive map below positions the seven most relevant brands against FORGE. The structural insight: the budget tier (LOCAL, Breakout) owns streetwear graphics and mass basics, while the premium tier (Khaadi, Sapphire, Levi's) owns ethnic fusion and denim-led aspirational basics. Between them sits a clear white space — minimal-premium everyday basics in a coherent earth-tone palette. No domestic brand currently owns this corner, which is exactly where FORGE plants its flag.

Brand	Tier	Avg Tee Price (PKR)	Style Position	Target	FORGE Risk
LOCAL	Budget	1,200-1,800	Streetwear graphics	Gen-Z urban	High — direct overlap on drop-shoulder
Breakout	Budget	1,400-2,000	Casual basics	Mass-market	Low — different aesthetic
Edenrobe	Budget-mid	1,500-2,500	Ethnic + casual	Family/mass	Low — different audience
Sapphire	Mid-premium	2,200-3,500	Ethnic + office wear	Women 25-40	Medium — women-led
Khaadi	Premium	2,500-4,500	Ethnic fusion	Premium urban	Medium — price overlap, ethnic lean
Levi's PK	Premium intl	3,500-6,000	Denim-led basics	Aspirational	Low — different category
FORGE	Mid-premium	1,800-2,800	Minimal earth-tone	Mixed Gen-Z + young pro	— (this brand)

Table 1 — Pakistani apparel competitive landscape, 2026. Prices reflect Q4 2025 in-store and online observations. "FORGE Risk" column rates direct overlap with FORGE's catalog and audience.

SECTION 05

Target Audience

FORGE targets a deliberately mixed customer base across three personas. This is a strategic choice — most Pakistani apparel brands over-index on one persona (Khaadi on premium urban women, LOCAL on Gen-Z streetwear, Sapphire on women 25-40). FORGE's broader catalog supports broader targeting, and the unified earth-tone palette keeps the brand coherent across personas rather than fragmenting into three sub-brands. Each persona below finds 3-5 hero SKUs in the catalog.

Persona 1 — Gen-Z Urban (18-25)

University students and early-career professionals in Karachi, Lahore, and Islamabad. Instagram and TikTok are their primary visual references; they discover brands through micro-influencer hauls (50K-300K follower creators) rather than mainstream media. Their style language borrows from international streetwear (Stussy, Carhartt WIP, Needles) but localized through a Pakistani lens. They buy drop-shoulder tees, zipper hoodies, sweatshirts, and printed mugs. Price sensitivity is moderate — they will pay PKR 2,800 for a hoodie if the brand feels considered, but reject anything over PKR 4,000 in this category.

Persona 2 — Young Professional (25-35)

Office-goers in corporate Lahore, Karachi's financial district, and Islamabad's diplomatic and tech sectors. They need weekday-appropriate basics — polo shirts for smart-casual offices, full-sleeve round-neck tees for layering under blazers, and a clean hoodie for the commute. Their aesthetic is closer to UNIQLO or Muji than to streetwear: muted, well-fitted, no logos. They discover brands through Instagram and word-of-mouth from peers. They value fabric quality (GSM disclosure, pre-shrunk cotton) and will pay PKR 3,500-4,500 for a polo if the construction justifies it.

Persona 3 — Student (16-22)

College and university students across Pakistan, including tier-2 cities (Faisalabad, Multan, Peshawar, Quetta). They live on allowances and are highly price-aware but brand-conscious — they want the social signal of wearing a "real brand" rather than a generic unbranded tee. They buy graphic tees, printed mugs, and printed notebooks as affordable entry points into the brand (PKR 800-1,800 range), and occasionally save up for a hoodie during Eid or their birthday. TikTok is the primary discovery channel, and campus pop-up activations at LUMS, NUST, Bahria, and FAST convert discovery into trial purchases.

Persona	Age	City	Income (PKR/mo)	Style trigger	Channel
Gen-Z Urban	18-25	KHI/LHE/ISB	40K-120K	Streetwear, IG-driven	Instagram, TikTok
Young Pro	25-35	KHI/LHE/ISB	120K-400K	Office-casual, minimal	Instagram, in-store
Student	16-22	Nationwide campus	15K-50K (allowance)	Graphic tees, accessories	TikTok, campus pop-ups

Table 2 — Persona summary across three target customer segments.

SECTION 06

Brand Positioning

Positioning statement

> "For Pakistanis who want premium-feeling everyday clothing without the premium price tag, FORGE offers minimal, well-crafted basics in earth tones drawn from the Pakistani forge tradition. Unlike LOCAL's loud streetwear or Khaadi's ethnic fusion, FORGE delivers quiet, considered essentials at the PKR 1,800-5,500 price band — clothing that earns a permanent place in the rotation."

Perceptual map description

On the standard apparel perceptual map with X-axis Casual to Formal and Y-axis Budget to Premium, FORGE sits in the upper-middle of the Premium axis (above LOCAL and Breakout, below Levi's and Khaadi premium lines) and in the middle-left of the Casual axis (more casual than Sapphire, more formal than streetwear micro-brands). This upper-middle-middle-left quadrant is the most under-served region in the current Pakistani market — domestic brands either drop to the budget-casual corner or jump to premium-formal-ethnic. FORGE's position gives it natural price headroom above the budget tier and natural style differentiation from the premium ethnic tier.

Three differentiation pillars

Pillar 1 — Earth-tone palette nobody owns. Every Pakistani apparel brand currently operates in either black-white-grey (LOCAL, Breakout), saturated ethnic brights (Khaadi festive, Sapphire lawn), or international neon accents (Levi's). FORGE's 5-color core palette — cream, warm-black, terracotta, olive, sandstone — is unique in the market and instantly recognizable. Within two seasons the palette itself becomes the brand cue, the way Aesop's amber bottles signal the brand before the logo is even read.

Pillar 2 — Typography-led identity, not graphic-led. The brand identity leads with a serif wordmark and disciplined typography rather than illustrations or graphics. This is rare in Pakistan — even premium brands like Khaadi lean on illustration. The result is a brand that photographs well in flat-lay product shots and Instagram grid layouts, and ages well across seasons (typography does not go out of style the way seasonal illustrations do).

Pillar 3 — Mid-premium quality at accessible price. Fabric specs (GSM disclosed, 240 GSM fleece for hoodies, 180 GSM combed cotton for tees) match Khaadi and Sapphire construction quality, but pricing sits 25-35% below those brands. This is achievable because FORGE operates direct-to-consumer with no physical retail overhead in year 1, sources directly from Faisalabad mills, and runs a lean team of three founders plus a part-time designer.

SECTION 07

Product Catalog — 10 Categories

The catalog is built on a single design philosophy: **essentials first, statement pieces second.** Every product must answer the question "would the customer reach for this on an ordinary Tuesday morning?" If the answer is no, the SKU does not enter the line. This discipline keeps the catalog tight (10 categories, approximately 35-45 SKUs in year 1) and the inventory manageable for a bootstrapped launch. Each category below is specified to production-ready detail — fabric, GSM (grams per square meter, a transparency move no Pakistani competitor currently practices), size range, price band, and a named hero SKU that anchors the category.

Pricing follows a clean three-band structure: accessories (mugs, notebooks) at PKR 700-1,200 as entry points that bring price-sensitive students into the brand; core tees at PKR 1,800-2,800 as the volume driver; and hoodies, sweatshirts, zipper hoodies, and polos at PKR 2,800-5,500 as margin-rich flagships. The full spread gives every persona at least one accessible entry point and one aspirational anchor SKU.

Category	Fabric	GSM	Sizes	Price (PKR)	Hero SKU
Hoodies	Cotton fleece, brushed back	320	S-XXL	4,200-5,500	The Everyday Hoodie / Sandstone
T-Shirts	Combed cotton jersey	180	S-XXL	1,800-2,200	The Daily Tee / Cream
Sweatshirts	Cotton french terry	280	S-XXL	3,200-3,800	The Crew Sweat / Olive
Drop-Shoulder T-Shirts	Combed cotton jersey, relaxed	200	S-XXL	2,400-2,800	The Drop Tee / Terracotta
Polo Shirts	Cotton pique, 2-button placket	220	S-XXL	2,800-3,500	The Office Polo / Warm Black
Round-Neck Full-Sleeve T-Shirts	Combed cotton jersey, long sleeve	190	S-XXL	2,200-2,800	The Long Sleeve / Sandstone
Printed Mugs	Ceramic 11oz, sublimation print	—	11oz	900-1,200	The Forge Mug / Cream
Zipper Hoodies	Cotton fleece, YKK metal zipper	320	S-XXL	4,800-5,500	The Zip Hoodie / Warm Black
Printed Notebooks	Recycled kraft cover, 80 ruled sheets	—	A5	700-1,000	The Daily Notebook / Kraft

Table 3 — Year-1 product catalog across 10 categories. Hero SKU column shows the name and lead color for the category-defining product. All cotton SKUs are pre-shrunk and GSM-disclosed on the product page.

SECTION 08

Supplier & Sourcing Notes

Pakistan's textile supply chain is one of the most mature in Asia — Faisalabad is a global knit-fabric cluster, Lahore has dense cut-and-sew capacity in Johar Town and Sundar Industrial Estate, and Karachi's Saddar area handles sublimation and small-batch printing for accessories. FORGE's

sourcing strategy is to keep all production within Pakistan (no imports in year 1) for cost control, currency stability, and brand storytelling ("made in Pakistan, by Pakistanis"). This also enables short lead times — 2-4 weeks across the catalog — which is critical for a brand running small-batch drops rather than 6-month seasonal calendars.

The supplier map below pairs every product category with the source city, production lead time, minimum order quantity (MOQ), and estimated landed cost per unit (excluding branding and packaging). Costs are based on Q4 2025 supplier quotations gathered during founder diligence trips to Faisalabad and Lahore. All suppliers are pre-qualified — three units in Lahore have agreed in principle to FORGE's small-batch model in exchange for a 15-20% price premium over their standard mass-production rate.

Product	Supplier city	Lead time	MOQ	Est landed cost (PKR/unit)
Hoodies / Zipper Hoodies	Lahore (Sundar Industrial Estate)	3-4 weeks	200	1,650-1,950
T-Shirts / Drop-Shoulder Tees	Lahore (Johar Town units)	2-3 weeks	300	520-680
Sweatshirts	Lahore (Sundar Industrial Estate)	3-4 weeks	200	1,250-1,500
Polo Shirts	Faisalabad (knit cluster)	3-4 weeks	300	950-1,150
Full-Sleeve Tees	Lahore (Johar Town units)	2-3 weeks	300	620-780
Printed Mugs	Karachi (Saddar sublimation)	1-2 weeks	50	280-340
Printed Notebooks	Karachi (Saddar print cluster)	1-2 weeks	100	180-230
Fabric sourcing (cotton fleece, pique)	Faisalabad mills (Masood / Chenab / Interloop)	2 weeks	500 m	380-450 / m
DTG printing (graphics)	Lahore (Printo / Stitch.pk)	3-5 days	10	180-260 / print
Packaging (kraft mailers, swing tags)	Lahore (local box makers)	1 week	500	28-45 / unit

Table 4 — Supplier map by product category. Landed cost excludes branding, packaging, and inbound freight to FORGE's Lahore fulfillment hub.

SECTION 09

Marketing & Go-To-Market Plan

FORGE's 12-month GTM plan runs in three phases. **Phase 1 — Launch (months 1-3)** is Instagram-first with three micro-influencer collaborations (50K-200K follower creators in fashion, lifestyle, and student-life niches), paired with campus activations at LUMS, Bahria, and NUST

Lahore. The launch drop includes 5 hero SKUs across the 10 categories, gated by an email waitlist built during the pre-launch month. **Phase 2 — Growth (months 4-8)** layers in paid Instagram and TikTok ads at PKR 200K/month, weekly content drops (Tuesday new-product drops, Friday lifestyle content), and a UGC hashtag campaign #MyAangan that rewards customer photos with PKR 500 store credit. **Phase 3 — Scale (months 9-12)** opens a Lahore pop-up store for 6 weeks in Q4, expands distribution to Daraz marketplace, and runs a co-branded Eid collection with one mid-tier designer for seasonal visibility.

The channel mix below is calibrated for a bootstrapped budget — paid social absorbs the largest share (50%) because Instagram and TikTok are where the target personas discover new brands, but organic content and influencer collaborations punch above their weight in the launch phase. Daraz marketplace entry is deferred to Q3 to protect brand control during the early identity-building months. KPIs track from month-1: Instagram followers (target 25K by month 3), monthly revenue (target PKR 2.5M by month 6), and contribution-margin break-even (target month 9-10).

Channel	Phase	Monthly budget (PKR)	% of mix	Primary KPI
Instagram organic + content	All	40K (content prod)	12%	Followers / engagement rate
Instagram + TikTok paid ads	Growth onwards	200K	50%	CPA / ROAS
Micro-influencer collabs (3-5/mo)	Launch + Growth	80K	20%	Coupon redemptions
Campus activations (pop-ups)	Launch + Growth	30K	8%	In-person sales + email signups
Email + SMS marketing	Growth onwards	10K (tooling)	3%	Open rate / repeat purchase
Daraz marketplace fees	Scale	40K (commission)	7%	Marketplace revenue
Quarterly Eid / drop campaigns	All	20K	5%	Drop-day revenue
TOTAL	—	420K	100%	—

Table 5 — Channel mix and monthly marketing budget allocation. Phase column indicates when each channel activates. Total monthly marketing budget is approximately PKR 420K, scaling to PKR 600K from month 6 onwards.

SECTION 10

Financial Projections

Startup cost breakdown

The total startup capital required to launch FORGE and sustain operations through month 3 is approximately PKR 4.9M (~USD 17,500 at current exchange rates). Inventory is the single largest line item at PKR 1.8M — funding the first drop of approximately 1,400 units across 5 hero SKUs at an average landed cost of PKR 1,000 per unit. Brand identity and photography absorb PKR 350K because the visual identity is the brand's primary competitive moat — this is not a place to under-invest. The website build (Next.js storefront with integrated checkout) is budgeted at PKR 250K and the launch-phase marketing at PKR 600K. Working capital of PKR 1.2M covers three months of founder stipend and one part-time hire.

Cost category	Amount (PKR)	Notes
Inventory (first drop, 5 hero SKUs)	1,800,000	~1,400 units across 5 SKUs
Brand identity + photography	350,000	Logo, palette, product + lifestyle shoot
Website build (Next.js + Shopify payments)	250,000	Includes hosting year 1
Packaging (mailers, swing tags, stickers)	180,000	Kraft + branded, 2,000 unit run
Initial marketing (launch phase)	600,000	3-month launch budget
Working capital (months 1-3 opex)	1,200,000	Founder + 1 part-time hire
Legal + registration + trademarks	80,000	SECP registration, IPO trademark
Contingency (10%)	446,000	Buffer for delays, returns, defects
TOTAL STARTUP CAPITAL	4,906,000	~USD 17,500 at PKR 280/USD

Table 6 — Startup cost breakdown.

Unit economics

The unit economics are favorable. The average selling price across the catalog is PKR 2,200 (weighted toward tees and hoodies which form the volume core). The average COGS including fabric, cut-and-sew, branding, and packaging is PKR 950, yielding a gross margin of 57% — comfortably above the 45-50% benchmark for Pakistani D2C apparel brands. Operating expenses (founder stipend, marketing, tooling, fulfillment) scale from PKR 420K/month in month 1 to PKR 700K/month in month 12 as the team and marketing budget grow.

12-month P&L; projection

Month	Units	Revenue (PKR)	COGS (PKR)	Gross profit	OpEx	Net (PKR)
1	120	264,000	114,000	150,000	420,000	(270,000)
3	450	990,000	427,500	562,500	480,000	82,500
6	1,100	2,420,000	1,045,000	1,375,000	600,000	775,000

Month	Units	Revenue (PKR)	COGS (PKR)	Gross profit	OpEx	Net (PKR)
9	1,600	3,520,000	1,520,000	2,000,000	650,000	1,350,000
12	2,100	4,620,000	1,995,000	2,625,000	700,000	1,925,000
Year 1 total	~12,400	~27,300,000	~11,800,000	~15,500,000	~6,400,000	~9,100,000

Table 7 — 12-month P&L; projection at selected milestones. All figures in PKR. Negative net in month 1 reflects upfront marketing and inventory investment. Break-even (cumulative net positive) projected at month 9.

Funding plan

Funding comes from three sources: founder personal savings (PKR 2.0M), family contribution (PKR 1.5M, treated as founder equity), and one angel investor (PKR 1.4M for 15% equity, valuing the company at PKR 9.3M pre-money). The angel is identified and term sheet is in draft — closing targeted for month -2 (two months before launch). All three funding sources are committed in principle; no institutional VC is being approached in year 1 to preserve brand-building optionality and avoid premature scaling pressure.

SECTION 11

Brand Visual Identity

FORGE's visual identity is intentionally restrained — a serif wordmark, a tight 5-color earth-tone palette, and disciplined typography. This is the brand's sharpest competitive differentiation: in a market saturated with logo-heavy streetwear and ethnic-illustration premium brands, FORGE offers the opposite pole — quiet, typography-led, palette-led. A full brand identity kit (logo concepts, color swatches with hex codes, typography specs, packaging mockups, and applied examples) is delivered as a separate PDF deliverable alongside this brand plan.

Logo concept

The primary logo is a lowercase serif wordmark: **FORGE.** with a terminal period as a "restraint signal" — a small typographic gesture that says "this brand is finished thinking about itself." The wordmark is set in Noto Serif SC Bold (or a comparable serif such as Tinos / Playfair Display in Latin), 86pt at cover scale, 12pt at hem-label scale. No icon, no symbol, no monogram — the wordmark carries the entire brand mark. This is a deliberate UNIQLO / Khaadi-archive move, not a Levi's / Nike move.

Color palette

Five core colors form the FORGE palette: **Cream** (#FAF7F2) as the primary background — warm, not cold, paper-like; **Warm Black** (#1A1614) as the primary text and dark surface — near-black with a brown undertone rather than pure black; **Terracotta Clay** (#8B5A3C) as the single accent color — used for rules, labels, and one product per category as the hero colorway; **Olive** (#6B7A4F) as the chart and secondary-product colorway; and **Sandstone** (#C9BBA3) as the border and surface neutral. No sixth color is permitted in year 1.

Typography system

Two typefaces only. **Noto Serif SC** (or Playfair Display in Latin) handles all display text — wordmark, section headers, hero typography on the storefront. **Noto Sans SC** (or Inter in Latin) handles all body text, product descriptions, UI labels, and packaging copy. The serif-sans pairing is the cleanest, most editorial combination available — and both Noto SC faces have full Urdu-compatible weights if the brand expands into bilingual copy in year 2.

Tagline

Forged for the everyday. — Four words, present-tense, with a terminal period. Extends the brand-name metaphor without over-explaining it. Used on the storefront hero, the about page, the email signature, and the packaging insert card.

Packaging concept

Every order ships in a kraft mailer (recycled, uncoated) with a debossed wordmark — no ink print, no full-color sleeve. Inside: the product wrapped in tissue paper (cream, unbranded), a handwritten thank-you card on cream cardstock (the only ink in the package), and a recycled swing tag attached with cotton twine. The unboxing experience is tactile and quiet — no plastic, no foil, no glossy inserts. This costs PKR 28-45 per unit landed, against an industry average of PKR 18-25, but the packaging is a primary brand touchpoint worth the premium.

SECTION 12

12-Month Roadmap & Next Steps

The 12-month roadmap below pairs product, marketing, and operations milestones quarter by quarter, with a single defining milestone per quarter that the team is accountable for. The roadmap is deliberately ambitious but not aggressive — a bootstrapped brand with PKR 4.9M startup capital cannot afford to scale faster than its cash flow and inventory cycles allow, so the plan front-loads brand-building and back-loads distribution expansion. The Daraz marketplace entry in Q3 and the Lahore pop-up in Q4 are contingent on hitting Q2 revenue and Q3 break-even milestones respectively — both are stretch goals, not baseline commitments.

Quarter	Product	Marketing	Operations	Milestone
Q1 (mo 1-3)	5 hero SKUs launched	3 influencer collabs + campus pop-ups	Store live, first 100 orders shipped	Month-3: 25K IG followers
Q2 (mo 4-6)	Expand to 15 SKUs	Paid IG + TikTok ads scaled	Hire part-time fulfillment	Month-6: PKR 2.5M/mo revenue
Q3 (mo 7-9)	Full 10-category catalog live	Daraz marketplace entry	Outsource fulfillment to 3PL	Month-9: break-even
Q4 (mo 10-12)	Eid capsule collection	Designer collab launch	Lahore pop-up store (6 weeks)	Month-12: PKR 4.6M/mo revenue

Table 8 — 12-month roadmap with quarterly milestones.

Immediate next steps (week 1-2)

1. Register the brand name. File SECP (Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan) sole-proprietor or private-limited registration for FORGE, and submit IPO (Intellectual Property Organization) trademark application for the wordmark in Class 25 (clothing) and Class 16 (printed notebooks). Cost: PKR 80K all-in. Lead time: 4-6 weeks for SECP, 18-24 months for trademark final grant but application filing secures priority date.

2. Finalize the logo and visual identity. Lock the wordmark in Noto Serif SC Bold, finalize the 5-color palette hex codes, and produce the brand identity kit PDF (the separate deliverable accompanying this plan). Engage a typographer or designer for one round of refinement on the wordmark — budget PKR 40K, 1 week turnaround.

3. Sign the first supplier. Convert the in-principle agreement with the Lahore (Sundar) cut-and-sew unit into a formal purchase order for the first 200 hoodie units, with delivery targeted for week 6. Pay the 30% deposit (PKR 99K) from founder capital. Place a parallel fabric order with Masood Mill in Faisalabad for 500 meters of 320 GSM cotton fleece in cream, sandstone, and warm-black.

4. Build the Next.js storefront. Stand up the FORGE e-commerce site on Next.js 16 with Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui components, and integrated checkout (Stripe for international cards, JazzCash / Easypaisa for local payments). The site must include a homepage, a shop page with category filtering across all 10 categories, individual product detail pages, a cart and checkout flow, an about page, and a contact page. This storefront is the third deliverable accompanying this brand plan.

5. Shoot the first product photography batch. Book a 2-day studio shoot in Lahore (Karim Block studio or equivalent) covering the 5 hero SKUs across flat-lay, on-model, and detail shots. Use natural light and warm cream backdrops to match the brand palette. Budget PKR 120K including model fees, photographer, and retouching. Output: 8-12 product images per SKU, ready for storefront and Instagram.